

John Whitton

Engineering Leadership
Architecture | Delivery | Organizational Scaling

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Professional Summary

Engineering leader, architect, and founder with experience building and scaling teams across financial infrastructure, enterprise platforms, distributed systems, blockchain networks, and execution systems.

Led engineering organizations ranging from startup teams to enterprise departments supporting 50+ staff, managed annual planning portfolios exceeding \$3M, and delivered 100+ initiatives spanning payments, integration, infrastructure, and platform engineering.

Combines deep technical architecture expertise with hiring, mentoring, organizational scaling, delivery execution, stakeholder management, budgeting, and cross-functional leadership.

Leadership Highlights

- Scaled Harmony engineering organization from 6 to 20 engineers through recruiting, onboarding, mentorship, and developer advocacy
- Led cross-functional team of 8–10 engineers, product, and research staff delivering stablecoin infrastructure, programmable money systems, and protocol services
- Managed annual planning and prioritization portfolio exceeding \$3M while coordinating delivery across 100+ concurrent initiatives
- Founded and scaled Global Enterprise Solutions to approximately \$800,000 annual revenue including recruiting, budgeting, partner management, consulting delivery, and operations
- Recruited and onboarded engineering teams across the United States, Africa, and Asia spanning backend, frontend, infrastructure, DevOps, and protocol engineering

Core Competencies

Leadership: Engineering Management, Organizational Scaling, Recruiting, Mentorship, Performance Management, Career Development, Delivery Execution, Roadmap Planning

Architecture: Distributed Systems, Platform Engineering, Enterprise Integration, Financial Infrastructure, APIs, Event-Driven Systems, Cloud Platforms

Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Postgres, MongoDB, gRPC, CI/CD, Datadog, PagerDuty

Languages: Rust, Go, TypeScript, Solidity

Business Operations: Budget Planning, Resource Allocation, Vendor Management, Partner Management, Executive Stakeholder Communication

Professional Experience

Principal Engineer / Founder

2018 – Present

Independent Research & Development

- Built and led research, protocol development, consulting, and fundraising initiatives spanning distributed systems, execution infrastructure, blockchain networks, and financial platforms

- Developed high-performance execution infrastructure evaluating 1000+ routes/sec and supporting millions of generated routes across multiple blockchain ecosystems
- Produced technical whitepapers, architecture specifications, investor materials, and secured approximately \$300,000 in investor commitments for the EAVE protocol initiative
- Managed technical strategy, architecture decisions, stakeholder engagement, and execution across multiple concurrent initiatives

Engineering Manager / Senior Protocol Engineer

Aug 2023 – Jan 2025

Eco Inc

- Led cross-functional team of 8–10 engineers, product, and research staff building stablecoin infrastructure, programmable money systems, and protocol services
- Owned hiring, onboarding, performance reviews, career development, and delivery execution across engineering initiatives
- Managed delivery across protocol, infrastructure, wallet, routing, proving, and platform engineering projects
- Coordinated cross-functional stakeholders to deliver production systems supporting stablecoin payments and distributed settlement infrastructure

Ecosystem Architect

Aug 2019 – May 2020

Harmony Protocol

- Scaled engineering organization from 6 to 20 engineers through recruiting, onboarding, mentorship, and team development
- Led delivery of mainnet launch, staking infrastructure, APIs, SDKs, validator systems, and ecosystem integrations
- Coordinated 50+ production network upgrades across distributed blockchain infrastructure supporting 300+ nodes and 600+ validators
- Developed intern and early-career engineering programs supporting long-term organizational growth

Chief Technology Officer

Jul 2016 – Jun 2018

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- Led distributed engineering teams across the United States and Africa delivering enterprise blockchain and loyalty platforms
- Managed engineering delivery, architecture, hiring, vendor coordination, and partner success initiatives
- Delivered enterprise platforms and integrations supporting IBM, Deloitte, Emirates Airlines, and CIBC partnerships
- Directed technical strategy, roadmap planning, and execution across multiple concurrent client and product initiatives

Enterprise Architect / Founder / Engineering Manager

1986 – 2016

EFI, Autodesk, Global Enterprise Solutions

- Managed annual planning and prioritization portfolio exceeding \$3M while coordinating delivery across 100+ initiatives and 50+ staff
- Built EFI Business Integration Services (EBIS), a service-oriented architecture integrating SAP, Salesforce, licensing, logistics, ecommerce, and manufacturing systems
- Founded and scaled Global Enterprise Solutions including recruiting 5 engineers and operations staff while managing budgets, legal vendors, accounting, partner relationships, and consulting delivery
- Led enterprise architecture, staffing, budgeting, delivery planning, and stakeholder management across global technology organizations

Education

Bachelor of Computer Science

University of Queensland